LocalChef Studio – User Guide

Version 1.6 · a short guide for everyday cooking. Details are in the documentation and in the app under the ❓ How to use button.

1. Getting started

Install: download `LocalChef_Studio_1.6.exe` from https://github.com/johnpreclik/localchef-studio/releases/latest and run it (SmartScreen: "More info → Run anyway"). The app appears in the Start menu.

Start: double-click `LocalChefStudio.exe` (or `py localchef_studio_v1.6.py`). On first start the **What's new and terms of use** window appears – read it to the end and click OK. If you like the app, you can support the author with the 🤍 **Donation** button (Ko-fi, PayPal, Revolut).

Offline translator: when it is missing, the app downloads it by itself and shows the progress in percent in a window (recipes can then be translated without internet and without keys). You can **Hide** the window (the download continues) or **Cancel** it. If it should not download automatically, tick **Don't download automatically next time**. You can download it any time in ⚙ **Settings** → 📥 **Download offline translator**.

Updates: when a new version is on GitHub, the app asks at start whether to download and install it. After **YES** it closes, installs the new version and starts again; recipes and settings stay. By hand: ⚙ **Settings** → 🔄 **Check for updates**.

Logging in to Cookidoo (Thermomix recipes only):

1. Click 🟤 Cookidoo.cz at the top.
2. Click log in on the website and enter your Cookidoo account.
3. Done – the app remembers the login after restarts.

Monsieur Cuisine and other sites need no login.

App language: ⚙ Settings → 🌐 UI → Čeština / English.

2. Find and save a recipe

Search: click 🏠 **Home**, type a name or ingredient and choose search by name or by ingredient. You will see recipes from your cookbook and from websites (Cookidoo, Monsieur Cuisine, Prima FRESH, Allrecipes, BBC Good Food). English sites are searched in English ("zelňačka" → "sauerkraut soup") and Czech sites in Czech; each site shows the term it used. The search bar stays at the top while scrolling.

One recipe:

1. Open a specific recipe (not a list of recipes).
2. Click 📥 **SAVE RECIPE** at the top.
3. Pick a category or type a new one and confirm.

From other sites only the recipe is kept: ingredients, method and tips, without ads or articles. Video-only pages cannot be saved.

3. Cooking with a recipe

1. Click a recipe in the list on the left.

2. Choose a view: **Recipe card** (the recipe in the app's design with a link to the source), **Thermomix Mode (TM6)** or **Monsieur Cuisine Smart (MCS)**.
3. Move between steps with **PREVIOUS STEP** and **NEXT STEP**.

What you see: dials with time, temperature and speed, the ingredient list with the ones for the current step highlighted, and the step text. A recipe for one robot is converted for the other automatically.

Useful buttons:

- **Batch** – scales amounts (e.g. double),
- **Detailed steps** – small actions like on the robot's display,
- **Metric** – converts ounces and cups to grams and millilitres,
- **Export to PDF** – a clean one-page recipe sheet.

Always check temperatures and times before cooking – conversions are machine-made.

4. Recipe on a phone or tablet

1. Phone and computer must be on the same Wi-Fi.
2. In the app, click **QR Code** at the bottom left.
3. Scan it with the phone's camera (or type the address from the Wi-Fi server line).
4. Pick a recipe on the phone and cook. The computer must stay on.

If the phone cannot connect, allow the app in Windows Firewall.

5. Translating a recipe

In the recipe bar click GB **English** or CZ **Čeština** (back to the original with **Original**). The translation runs in the background and is stored – next time it just loads. → **Translate all recipes** translates the whole cookbook.

The app translates with DeepL or Gemini (with a key), otherwise with the offline translator. A recipe that is already in English is not translated into English. You can keep using the app while it translates, even the whole cookbook.

6. Keys for better translations and conversions (free)

- **Gemini** (best conversions between robots): https://aistudio.google.com/app/apikey → sign in with a Google account → **Create API key** → paste it in → Gemini AI Key. Free, no card, daily limits.
- **DeepL** (most accurate translations): https://www.deepl.com/pro-api → **DeepL API Free** (500,000 characters a month free; card for verification only) → copy the key from API Keys and paste it in → DeepL.

Keys stay only on your computer. Never share them.

7. Backing up and moving recipes

Export: select recipes in the list on the left (**Ctrl + click**, **Shift + click**, or click a whole category) → right-click → **Export backup (.7z)**. One file is created in the `exported_recipes` folder.

Import: on the other computer click **Import recipes (.7z)** on the left and pick one or

more files. If you already have a recipe, the app asks whether to replace it.

The whole cookbook: close the app and copy the `localchef_data` folder next to the program.

Delete: 🗑 Delete moves a recipe to the `recipes_smazane` trash – nothing is lost for good.

8. When something goes wrong

Problem	What to do
A Cookidoo recipe has no steps	log in, wait for the page to load and save again
A recipe cannot be saved	try the same recipe from another site via 🏠 Home
Odd steps	save the recipe again
Translation fails	add a Gemini key or download the offline translator in ⚙
The phone cannot connect	same Wi-Fi, allow the app in the firewall

Error details are in `localchef_data/app.log`.

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